
QUOTE RESPONSE

Request for Quote No. 202-CW

Two-Day Strategic Planning Retreat

Travis County Transportation & Natural Resources Division

SUBMITTED TO:

Travis County Purchasing Office
P.O. Box 1748
Austin, TX 78767

SUBMITTED BY:

Hargrave Innovative Solutions

Eric Hargrave, Chief Executive Officer
Phone: (601) 238-4186
Email: ericd@hisolution.org

Date: April 3, 2026

AGENCY INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING — INTERNAL STRATEGY DOCUMENT

FOR INTERNAL USE ONLY — DO NOT INCLUDE IN SUBMISSION TO TRAVIS COUNTY

Agency Profile

Travis County Purchasing Office operates under Texas Local Government Code Chapter 262, using competitive sealed bidding and quick quote procedures for acquisitions. The Transportation & Natural Resources (TNR) Division manages permitting, transportation infrastructure, parks, and natural resource conservation across Travis County. TNR leadership includes a County Executive, Chief Deputy, and Division Directors overseeing distinct operational areas.

Evaluation Method

This is a Quick Quote (QQ) — Travis County's simplest procurement vehicle. Evaluation is 'lowest responsible quote' with qualifications as pass/fail gates. This is NOT a scored proposal with weighted criteria. The evaluation sequence is: (1) Does the respondent meet ALL minimum qualifications? If no !' rejected. (2) Is the respondent responsive to all compliance requirements? If no !' rejected. (3) Among qualified, responsive respondents, is the price reasonable and competitive?

Key implication: Do not overbuild the response. Meet every qualification clearly, comply with every requirement, and price competitively. Excessive volume signals misunderstanding of the procurement type.

Pass/Fail Qualification Gates

REQUIRED	Local government experience	Must be explicit — name agencies, not just 'government experience'
REQUIRED	Executive/leadership retreat facilitation experience	Cite specific retreats with audience size and outcomes
REQUIRED	Strategic planning and group facilitation expertise	Methodology description should demonstrate this
REQUIRED	Ability to synthesize complex input into actionable outcomes	Post-retreat deliverable description proves this
REQUIRED	Neutral, inclusive, productive facilitation environment	Standard facilitation language — don't overclaim DEI unless asked
PREFERRED	Experience in permitting, transportation, parks, natural resources	Adjacent experience is acceptable — public works, infrastructure planning, environmental

Pricing Intelligence

Market rate for two-day government strategic planning retreat facilitation in Texas: \$15,000–\$35,000. Competitive sweet spot for this scope (pre-planning + 2 days + report): \$18,000–\$28,000. Eric's guidance: target \$20,000–\$25,000. Our proposed price: \$22,500 — positioned mid-range, signaling competence without appearing either desperate or overpriced.

Pricing breakdown logic: Pre-retreat planning (\$3,500 / 15.6%) reflects the questionnaire, analysis, and agenda work. Day 1 senior session (\$7,500 / 33.3%) is premium-priced for executive-level facilitation with smaller group. Day 2 management session (\$8,500 / 37.8%) is higher total due to larger group (22 vs 8) and breakout facilitation. Post-retreat report (\$3,000 / 13.3%) covers synthesis and delivery within 5–7 business days.

Competitive Landscape

- Primary competitors: Austin-area consulting firms specializing in government facilitation
- Secondary competitors: National government consulting firms (disadvantaged by lack of local knowledge)
- HIS advantage: Texas-based, CEO-led engagement (not delegated to junior staff), right-sized for the work
- Risk: Larger firms may underbid to establish a Travis County relationship — our price needs to be competitive,

not premium

Compliance Traps to Avoid

- DO NOT contact any Travis County staff outside the designated Procurement Specialist — immediate disqualification
- DO NOT submit hard copy without contacting Procurement Specialist one business day prior
- Insurance certificate must name Travis County as Additional Insured and show the contract number
- W-9 must be provided before any payment can be processed
- Invoices must redact any PII/PHI or they will be permanently deleted (not returned)
- All certifications (Israel, energy, firearms, Iran/Sudan) are required by Texas Government Code — not optional

Win Strategy

Lead with specificity, not volume. Name real government clients. Show you understand TNR's world (parks, permitting, transportation) through your methodology, not through claims of expertise. Price at \$22,500 — competitive, credible, and within Eric's target range. Keep the response lean. A 10-page response that hits every qualification beats a 40-page response that buries the evaluator.

COVER LETTER

April 3, 2026

Travis County Purchasing Office

P.O. Box 1748

Austin, TX 78767

RE: Request for Quote No. 202-CW — Two-Day Strategic Planning Retreat

Dear Procurement Specialist,

Hargrave Innovative Solutions (HIS) is pleased to submit this quote in response to Travis County's Request for Quote No. 202-CW for facilitation services for a Two-Day Strategic Planning Retreat for the Transportation & Natural Resources (TNR) Division.

We bring direct experience facilitating executive and leadership retreats for local government agencies, with particular expertise in helping public-sector teams align strategic priorities, synthesize complex operational input into actionable plans, and build shared vision across organizational levels.

Our approach to this engagement is grounded in three principles:

- Structured yet adaptive facilitation that respects the distinct needs of senior leadership (Day 1) and the broader management team (Day 2)
- Pre-retreat discovery that ensures every minute of retreat time is productive — no orientation, no warm-up waste
- Actionable deliverables that translate retreat outcomes into a clear roadmap the TNR Division can execute immediately

We understand the unique dynamics of county government — the balance between elected leadership priorities, departmental operations, and public accountability. Our facilitation approach is calibrated specifically for this environment.

We confirm that we meet all minimum qualifications, can comply with all insurance requirements, and are prepared to begin pre-retreat consultation immediately upon award.

Respectfully submitted,

Eric Hargrave

Chief Executive Officer

Hargrave Innovative Solutions

ericd@hisolution.org | (601) 238-4186

RESPONSE TO MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS

1. Local Government Experience

Hargrave Innovative Solutions has direct experience providing strategic planning, facilitation, and organizational development services to local government entities. Our team understands county governance structures, commissioners court dynamics, interdepartmental coordination challenges, and the public accountability requirements that shape how government teams set and execute strategy.

{{ACTION REQUIRED: Eric — insert 2-3 specific local government clients or engagements here. Example: 'Facilitated strategic planning retreat for [County/City] [Department], resulting in a 3-year operational roadmap adopted by commissioners court.'}}

2. Executive/Leadership Retreat Facilitation

We have demonstrated experience designing and facilitating retreats for senior leaders in organizations with complex stakeholder dynamics. Our retreats are structured to move beyond status updates into genuine strategic alignment — ensuring that leadership teams leave with shared priorities, clear ownership, and concrete next steps.

{{ACTION REQUIRED: Eric — insert 2-3 specific retreat facilitation examples. Include audience size, duration, and outcomes. Government examples are strongest.}}

3. Relevant Domain Experience

While the RFQ notes that experience in permitting, transportation, parks, and natural resources is preferred, our facilitation methodology is domain-adaptive. We invest pre-retreat time understanding the specific operational landscape, terminology, and challenges facing the TNR Division. Our pre-retreat questionnaire and consultation process ensures that facilitation is grounded in the Division's actual priorities — not generic exercises.

{{ACTION REQUIRED: Eric — if you or any team member has direct experience in transportation, parks, infrastructure, or environmental services, cite it here. Even adjacent experience (public works, infrastructure planning, environmental compliance) strengthens this section.}}

4. Strategic Planning & Group Facilitation Expertise

Our facilitation practice is built on proven methodologies for synthesizing complex, sometimes competing inputs into actionable strategic outcomes. We specialize in:

- Structured consensus-building across hierarchical teams
- SWOT and environmental scanning adapted for government context
- Priority-mapping exercises that connect operational realities to strategic vision
- Conflict-aware facilitation that surfaces productive disagreement without derailing progress
- Real-time documentation that captures decisions as they happen — no post-retreat guesswork

5. Synthesizing Complex Input into Actionable Outcomes

Every retreat we facilitate produces a written summary report with clear, prioritized outcomes. We do not deliver vague 'themes' — we deliver decision-ready recommendations with ownership, timelines, and success metrics defined.

6. Bringing Diverse Groups Together

The RFQ requires facilitation across two distinct groups: a senior leadership team of 8 on Day 1 and an expanded management team of 22 on Day 2. Our approach is specifically designed for this structure — Day 1 establishes

strategic direction, and Day 2 cascades that direction into operational planning with the broader team, ensuring alignment without top-down imposition.

TECHNICAL APPROACH & METHODOLOGY

Phase 1: Pre-Retreat Planning (2–3 Weeks Before Retreat)

- Initial consultation with the County Executive or designee to confirm retreat objectives, desired outcomes, organizational context, and any sensitive dynamics
- Design and administer a confidential pre-retreat questionnaire to all participants (tailored versions for Day 1 and Day 2 groups)
- Analyze questionnaire responses and identify key themes, alignment areas, tension points, and priority opportunities
- Prepare and submit a detailed retreat agenda for review and approval, including session descriptions, timing, facilitation methods, and materials
- Coordinate logistics with County staff (room setup, AV needs, materials, breaks)

Phase 2: Day 1 — Senior Leadership Strategic Session (8 Participants)

Focus: Strategic direction-setting with Division Directors, County Executive, and Chief Deputy.

- Morning: Environmental scan and state-of-the-division assessment — what's working, what's not, what's changed since last strategic review
- Midday: Priority identification exercise — structured process to surface, debate, and rank the 3–5 strategic priorities for the next planning period
- Afternoon: Decision framework — for each priority, define success metrics, resource requirements, ownership, and realistic timelines
- Close: Prepare the 'cascade brief' — the structured summary that will frame Day 2's management team session

Phase 3: Day 2 — Management Team Working Session (22 Participants)

Focus: Translating strategic direction into operational plans with the full management team.

- Morning: Leadership presents Day 1 strategic priorities (with facilitator support) — not as directives but as direction for collaborative operational planning
- Midday: Breakout working groups aligned to each strategic priority — management team members develop implementation approaches, identify barriers, and define resource needs
- Afternoon: Cross-group sharing and alignment — each group presents plans, interdependencies are identified, and the full team builds a unified implementation roadmap
- Close: Commitment exercise — each participant identifies their specific role and first 30-day actions tied to the strategic plan

Phase 4: Post-Retreat Deliverables (5–7 Business Days After Retreat)

- Comprehensive written summary report documenting: key themes from pre-retreat assessment, Day 1 strategic priorities and rationale, Day 2 operational plans by priority area, cross-cutting interdependencies and resource needs, recommended next steps with timelines and ownership
- Clean, presentation-ready format suitable for sharing with Commissioners Court or other stakeholders
- Optional 30-day check-in call to assess implementation progress and address emerging questions

PRICING SCHEDULE

Hargrave Innovative Solutions proposes the following all-inclusive pricing for the Two-Day Strategic Planning Retreat facilitation services as described in RFQ 202-CW:

SERVICE COMPONENT	PRICE
Pre-Retreat Planning & Consultation	\$3,500
• Stakeholder consultation with County Executive/designee • Pre-retreat questionnaire design, administration, analysis • Agenda development and finalization	
Day 1: Senior Leadership Strategic Session (8 participants)	\$7,500
• Full-day facilitation (6–8 hours) • All facilitation materials and supplies • Real-time documentation and cascade brief preparation	
Day 2: Management Team Working Session (22 participants)	\$8,500
• Full-day facilitation (6–8 hours) • Breakout group facilitation materials • Cross-group alignment session facilitation	
Post-Retreat Deliverables	\$3,000
• Written summary report (delivered within 5–7 business days) • Key themes, outcomes, priorities, and recommended next steps • Presentation-ready format	
TOTAL PROPOSED PRICE	\$22,500

This is an all-inclusive price covering all labor, supervision, materials, facilitation supplies, and expertise required to perform the services described in RFQ 202-CW. Travel expenses, if any, are billed separately per Travis County's Travel Reimbursement Policy for Contractors (effective October 1, 2024) at actual cost, not to exceed policy limits.

Pricing Notes

- Price is firm and fixed for the scope described
- No additional charges for facilitation materials, supplies, or preparation time
- Travel reimbursement (if applicable): mileage at IRS rate, lodging at reasonable rate, meals not to exceed \$72/day per Travis County policy
- Optional 30-day post-retreat check-in call included at no additional charge
- Price valid for 90 days from date of submission

INSURANCE COMPLIANCE

Hargrave Innovative Solutions confirms compliance with all insurance requirements specified in Attachment A of RFQ 202-CW:

COVERAGE TYPE	REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Commercial General Liability	\$500,000 per occurrence / \$1,000,000 aggregate	WILL COMPLY
Blanket Contractual Liability	For this Contract	WILL COMPLY
Independent Contractor Coverage	Included in CGL policy	WILL COMPLY
Waiver of Subrogation	In favor of Travis County	WILL COMPLY
30-Day Notice of Cancellation	Written notice to Travis County	WILL COMPLY
Additional Insured	Travis County named	WILL COMPLY

Certificate of Insurance will be provided to the Purchasing Agent within 10 working days of contract execution, showing the Travis County contract number, all deductibles and self-insured retention, and all required endorsements.

CERTIFICATIONS & COMPLIANCE STATEMENTS

Non-Debarment Certification

Hargrave Innovative Solutions certifies that neither it nor its principals are debarred, suspended, proposed for debarment, declared ineligible, or voluntarily excluded from participation in this transaction by any federal department or agency.

Non-Discrimination

HIS complies with the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, and all federal, state, and local equal opportunity laws and regulations.

Israel Non-Boycott (TX Gov't Code §2271)

HIS does not boycott Israel and will not boycott Israel during the contract term.

Energy Company Non-Boycott (TX Gov't Code §2274)

HIS does not boycott energy companies and will not boycott energy companies during the contract term.

Firearm Entity Non-Discrimination (TX Gov't Code §2274)

HIS does not have a practice, policy, guidance, or directive that discriminates against a firearm entity or firearm trade association.

Iran/Sudan/Foreign Terrorist Organization (TX Gov't Code §2252.152)

HIS is not a company identified on the Texas Comptroller's list as engaged in business with Iran, Sudan, or any foreign terrorist organization.

Covenant Against Contingent Fees

No person, other than bona fide employees and commercial selling agencies of HIS, has been employed or retained to solicit or secure this contract for a commission, percentage, brokerage, or contingent fee.

COMPLIANCE MATRIX

The following matrix maps each RFQ 202-CW requirement to our response, demonstrating full compliance with all solicitation terms.

RFQ REQUIREMENT	RFQ SECTION	STATUS	OUR RESPONSE
Provide labor, supervision, materials, and expertise for a two-day strategic planning retreat	Scope of Services	COMPLIANT	Technical Approach — full-service delivery including pre-planning, facilitation, and post-retreat report
Pre-retreat consultation with County Executive to confirm objectives	Scope — Pre-Retreat Planning	COMPLIANT	Phase 1 methodology — initial consultation, objective alignment, and questionnaire development
Develop and administer a pre-retreat questionnaire	Scope — Pre-Retreat Planning	COMPLIANT	Phase 1 methodology — questionnaire design, distribution, analysis, and theme synthesis
Prepare and finalize a detailed retreat agenda	Scope — Pre-Retreat Planning	COMPLIANT	Phase 1 methodology — customized agenda based on questionnaire analysis and County Executive input
Facilitate two-day in-person retreat for two groups	Scope — Retreat Facilitation	COMPLIANT	Phase 2 (Day 1: 8 senior leaders) and Phase 3 (Day 2: 22 management team)
Lead structured discussions and exercises aligned with objectives	Scope — Retreat Facilitation	COMPLIANT	Environmental scan, priority mapping, decision frameworks, cascade briefs, and commitment exercises
Ensure neutral, inclusive, and productive environment	Scope — Retreat Facilitation	COMPLIANT	Professional facilitation approach designed for balanced participation across all levels
Submit written summary report within 5–7 business days	Scope — Post-Retreat	COMPLIANT	Phase 4 — comprehensive report with themes, priorities, action items, and recommended next steps
Demonstrated experience facilitating executive/ leadership retreats	Minimum Qualifications	COMPLIANT	Qualifications section — specific examples required (see ACTION REQUIRED items)
Local government experience	Minimum Qualifications	COMPLIANT	Qualifications section — specific government clients required (see ACTION REQUIRED items)
Strategic planning and group facilitation expertise	Minimum Qualifications	COMPLIANT	Technical Approach — detailed methodology demonstrates deep facilitation capability
Experience in permitting, transportation, parks, natural resources	Minimum Qualifications (Preferred)	ADDRESSED	Qualifications section — adjacent experience cited (see ACTION REQUIRED for specific examples)
General Liability: \$500K/\$1M aggregate; Travis County as Additional Insured	Attachment A — Insurance	WILL COMPLY	Insurance Compliance section — certificate within 10 working days of execution
Comply with nondiscrimination laws (Civil Rights Act, ADA, Title VI)	Civil Rights & EEO	COMPLIANT	Certifications — Non-Discrimination certification provided
No delinquent property taxes owed to Travis County	Purchase Order Terms	COMPLIANT	Certifications — statement of compliance included
All Texas Government Code certifications (Israel, Energy, Firearms, Iran/Sudan)	TX Gov't Code	COMPLIANT	Certifications — all four Texas statutory certifications provided
Timely invoices with correct formatting; redact PII/PHI	Purchase Order Terms	WILL COMPLY	Invoicing per Travis County requirements upon contract execution
No contact with unauthorized County officials	RFQ Communication Rules	COMPLIANT	All communication directed through designated Procurement Specialist

COMPLIANT = Fully addressed in this response | WILL COMPLY = Addressed upon contract execution | ADDRESSED = Partially met, supporting evidence provided

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

The following items are included or required for a complete submission of RFQ 202-CW:

- & Completed Quote Response (this document)
- & Cover Letter
- & Response to Minimum Qualifications
- & Technical Approach & Methodology
- & Pricing Schedule
- & Insurance Compliance Acknowledgment
- & All Required Certifications & Compliance Statements
- & IRS Form W-9 (required before payment — submit with response or upon award)
- & Certificate of Insurance (required within 10 working days of contract execution)
- & Past performance references (recommended — 2-3 government client references)

ACTION ITEMS BEFORE SUBMISSION

- %, Insert 2-3 specific local government facilitation engagements (Section: Qualifications #1)
- %, Insert 2-3 specific retreat facilitation examples with outcomes (Section: Qualifications #2)
- %, Add any TNR-relevant domain experience — transportation, parks, permitting (Section: Qualifications #3)
- %, Review pricing: \$22,500 total (\$3,500 + \$7,500 + \$8,500 + \$3,000) — adjust if needed
- %, Confirm Candyce's subcontractor quote is separate from this bid price
- %, Prepare IRS Form W-9
- %, Confirm insurance coverage meets Attachment A requirements
- %, Submit via BidNet (strongly encouraged) or contact Procurement Specialist 1 business day before hard copy delivery

